resolution X-ray telescope, called “Einstein,” and it is launched into orbit. [Ch. 8]1

1979 Townes and others discover evidence for a 3-million-solar-mass black hole at the center of our galaxy. [Ch. 9]

Drever initiates an interferometric gravitational-wave detection project at Caltech.[Ch. 10]

1982 Bunting and Mazur prove the no-hair conjecture for spinning, electrically charged black holes. [Ch. 7]

1983–1988 Phinney and others develop comprehensive black-hole-based models to explain the full details of quasars and radio galaxies. [Ch. 9]

1984 The National Science Foundation forges a shotgun marriage between the Caltech and MIT gravitational-wave detection efforts, giving rise to the LIGO Project. [Ch. 10]

Redmount (building on earlier work by Eardley) shows that radiation falling into an empty, spherical wormhole gets accelerated to high energy and greatly speeds up the wormhole’s pinch-off. [Ch. 14]

1985–1993 Thorne, Morris, Yurtsever, Friedman, Novikov, and others probe the laws of physics by asking whether they permit traversable wormholes and time machines. [Ch. 14]

1987 Vogt becomes director of the LIGO Project, and it then begins to move forward vigorously. [Ch. 10]

1990 Kim and Thorne show that, whenever one tries to create a time machine, by any method whatsoever, an intense beam of vacuum fluctuations circulates through the machine at the moment it is first created. [Ch. 14]

1991 Hawking proposes the chronology protection conjecture (that the laws of physics forbid time machines) and argues that it will be enforced by the circulating beam of vacuum fluctuations destroying any time machine at its moment of formation. [Ch. 14]